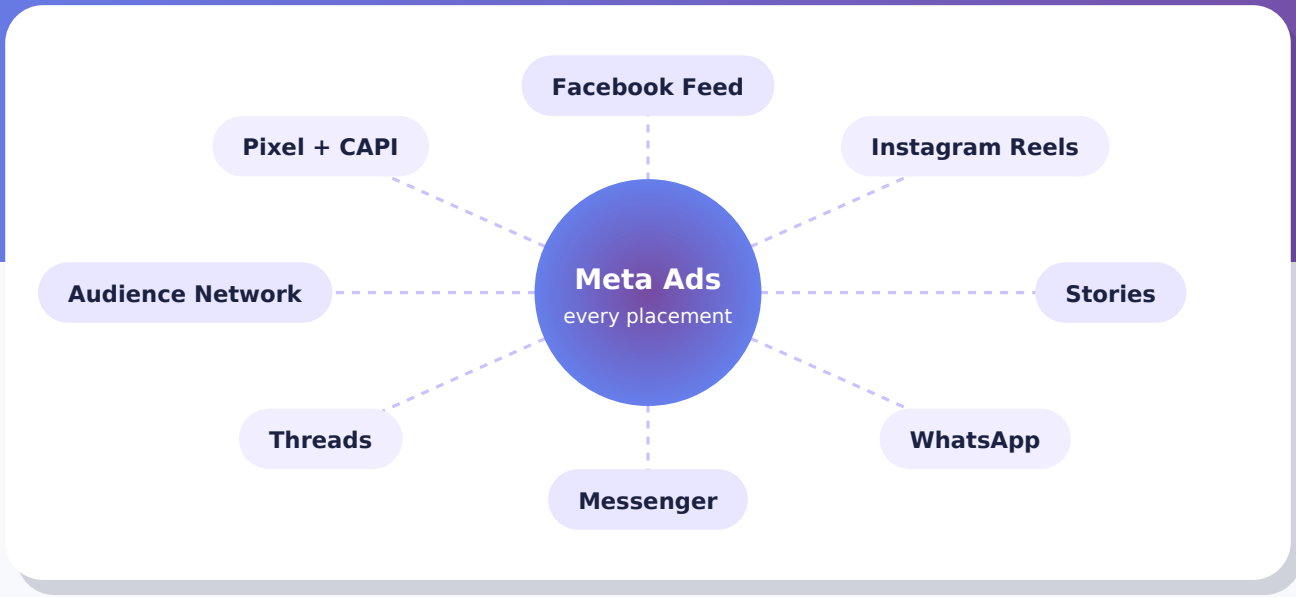
WEEK 8 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Meta Ads: Facebook & Instagram

Campaigns, audiences, creative, WhatsApp and tracking for businesses in Mauritius, step by step

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PART A

Foundations

Why Meta ads, how the auction works, and how to set up your accounts and payment in Mauritius

SECTION 1

Why advertise on Meta

Meta ads are the paid adverts you run on Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, WhatsApp, Threads and the Audience Network of partner apps. You create and manage them in one tool, **Meta Ads Manager**. For most businesses in Mauritius, Meta is the first and often the biggest paid channel, because this is where local customers spend their time.

Organic social vs Meta ads

In Week 5 you learned to grow on social media for free (organic). Organic reach is unpredictable: even good posts reach only part of your followers. Ads give you three things organic content cannot: **guaranteed reach**, **precise targeting** and **measurable results** such as leads and sales.

	Boosted post	Ads Manager campaign
Where you create it	The "Boost" button on a Facebook or Instagram post	Ads Manager (adsmanager.facebook.com) or the Meta Business Suite
Objectives	A few simple goals (more messages, website visitors, engagement)	All six objectives (Section 6)
Audience and placements	Basic	Full control or Advantage+ automation
Testing and tracking	Very limited	A/B tests, Pixel, Conversions API, detailed reports
Best for	Giving a good organic post more reach	Any campaign with a business goal and a budget

Meta’s reach in Mauritius

Platform	Ad reach in Mauritius (DataReportal, Digital 2026)	Share of adults 18+
Facebook	About 886,000 people (69.9% of the population)	85.5%
Messenger	About 599,000 (47.2%)	57.6%
Instagram	About 418,000 (33.0%)	40.0%

These are Meta’s advertising audience estimates, not active users. Meta itself says estimated audience size is not a proxy for daily or monthly active users. Use them to compare platforms and plan, not as exact numbers.

What this means

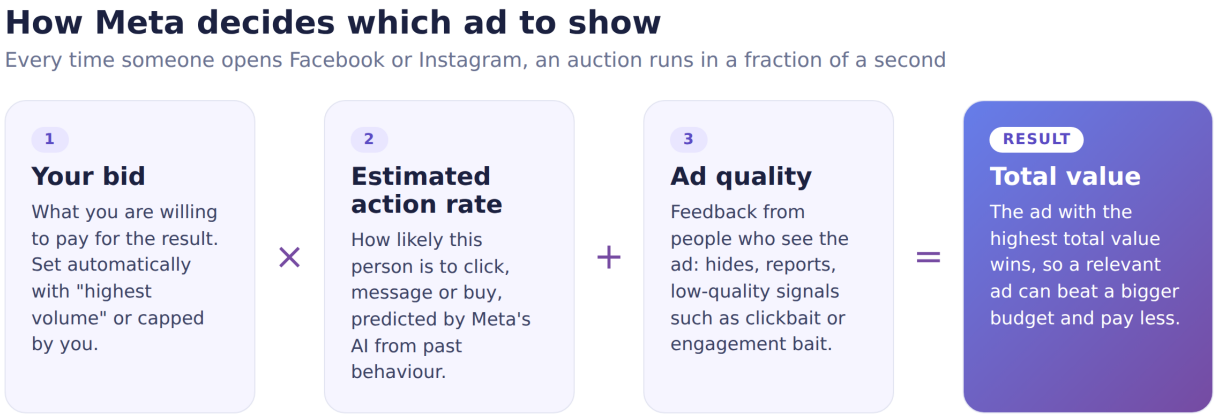
- **Facebook reaches most adults** in Mauritius: almost any local business can find its customers there.
- **Instagram is smaller but younger and more visual**: strong for food, fashion, beauty, events and tourism.
- **WhatsApp is where the sale happens**: Meta ads that open a WhatsApp chat (Section 17) are one of the most useful formats for Mauritian SMEs (small and medium-sized enterprises).
- **The market is small**: you will reach the same people often. Watch frequency (Section 25) and refresh creative regularly.

> **In Mauritius:** a café in Port Louis, a guesthouse in Trou aux Biches and a training company in Ebène can all run effective Meta campaigns from a few hundred rupees a day. The skill is not the budget, it is choosing the right objective, audience, creative and measurement.

SECTION 2

How Meta ads work

Every time someone opens Facebook or Instagram, Meta runs an auction in a fraction of a second to decide which ads to show in that person's feed, stories or reels. Understanding the auction explains why good ads pay less.



The three parts of the auction

- **Bid:** what you are willing to pay for your chosen result. Most advertisers let Meta bid automatically ("highest volume").
- **Estimated action rate:** Meta's prediction of how likely this person is to take the action you optimise for (click, message, lead, purchase).
- **Ad quality:** based on how people react to the ad, including hides and reports, and on signals of low quality such as clickbait, engagement bait or withheld information.

Because relevance counts as much as money, an ad that people like and act on can win auctions against bigger budgets and pay a lower cost per result.

Meta's AI does most of the targeting now

Since 2024 Meta has rebuilt its ad delivery around large AI models that choose which ad to show to which person. In practice this means:

- **Broad audiences often work**: you give Meta a location, a minimum age and good creative, and it finds the buyers.
- **Creative is the new targeting**:different videos and images attract different people, so a variety of creatives helps the system find more customers (Section 20).
- **Clean conversion data is essential**: the algorithm learns from the events you send (Pixel and Conversions API, Sections 11–12). Wrong data teaches it the wrong thing.
- **Fewer, bigger campaigns** learn faster than many tiny ones (Section 22).

What you pay for

Most Meta ads are charged per 1,000 impressions (CPM, cost per mille), whatever objective you choose. Some ad sets can be charged per link click. Your **cost per result** depends on how many results you get for the impressions you buy: better creative and better targeting mean more results for the same spend.

> **Tip:** think of Meta as a very fast media buyer that works for you. Your job is to give it a clear goal (objective and conversion event), good material (creative) and honest feedback (tracking).

SECTION 3

The Meta advertising toolkit

Meta has several tools with similar names. Here is what each one does and when you will use it.

Tool	What it is for	Where
Business portfolio (formerly Business Manager)	Owns your Pages, Instagram accounts, WhatsApp accounts, ad accounts, Pixels and people's access	business.facebook.com → Settings
Ad account	Holds campaigns, payment method, currency and time zone	Inside the business portfolio
Facebook Page	The identity that appears on your ads; required to advertise	facebook.com
Instagram professional account	Lets ads appear under your Instagram name and lets you reply to comments	Linked to the Page and portfolio
WhatsApp Business account	Receives chats from click-to-WhatsApp ads	WhatsApp Business app or Business Platform (API), linked to the Page
Ads Manager	Create, edit, test and report on campaigns	adsmanager.facebook.com
Meta Business Suite	Posts, inbox, insights and simple ads for small businesses	business.facebook.com
Events Manager	Pixel, Conversions API, events, custom conversions, data sources	Business portfolio → Events Manager
Commerce Manager	Catalogues and shops for product ads	business.facebook.com/commerce
Meta Ad Library	Public search of all active ads, including competitors	facebook.com/ads/library

Access and roles

In a business portfolio, people get **full control** (admins) or **partial access** to specific assets and tasks (for example, "create ads" on one ad account, "view performance" only). Agencies and freelancers should be added as **partners**, so the business keeps ownership of everything.

> **Never** run a business's ads from a freelancer's personal ad account, and never let one person be the only admin. If that person leaves or is hacked, the business loses its Page, its data and its ad history. Week 5, Section 26, has the security checklist.

SECTION 4

Setting up your business portfolio and ad account

Do this once, properly, and every campaign afterwards will be easier to run, track and hand over.

Step by step

1. Go to **business.facebook.com** and create a business portfolio with the legal business name, a business email and your details. Use a real personal Facebook profile as the admin (Meta does not allow fake profiles).
2. In **Settings → Accounts → Pages**, add your Facebook Page (or request access if an agency owns it).
3. In **Settings → Accounts → Instagram accounts**, connect your Instagram professional account.
4. In **Settings → Accounts → WhatsApp accounts**, connect your WhatsApp Business number (or link it from the Page settings: Linked accounts → WhatsApp).
5. In **Settings → Accounts → Ad accounts**, create a new ad account. Choose the **time zone** (Indian/Mauritius, GMT+4) and the **currency** carefully (Section 5): changing them later means creating a new ad account.
6. Add a second admin and turn on two-factor authentication for everyone.
7. In **Events Manager**, create a dataset (Pixel) for your website (Section 11).
8. Verify your business (Security Center → Business verification) when Meta asks for it: it increases trust and unlocks some features. Keep your BRN (Business Registration Number) document ready.
9. Verify your website domain in Settings → Brand safety → Domains (Section 12).

Before you create the first campaign

- ☐ Page complete: logo, cover, description, contact details, WhatsApp button
- ☐ Instagram linked to the Page and to the portfolio
- ☐ Ad account with the right name, currency and time zone
- ☐ Payment method added and tested (Section 5)
- ☐ Pixel installed and tested (Section 11)
- ☐ At least two admins, all with two-factor authentication

> **Tip:** name your ad account clearly, for example "Lagon Bleu – Ads – USD". With agencies and multiple businesses, clear names avoid expensive mistakes.

SECTION 5

Payment and billing in Mauritius

Currency: why your account will not be in rupees

The Mauritian rupee (MUR) is not in Meta's list of supported ad account currencies. Mauritian businesses usually choose **US dollars (USD)** or **euros (EUR)**. Your bank converts the charges to rupees and may add a currency conversion fee, so ask your bank about fees on foreign card payments. In this guide, budgets are given in rupees to make planning easy; type the converted amount in your account currency in Ads Manager.

Payment methods

Method	How it works	Tips
Debit or credit card (Visa, Mastercard)	Automatic payments: Meta charges your card when you reach a billing threshold and on a monthly bill date	Make sure the card is enabled for international online payments
Business card or virtual card	Same as above, separate from personal spending	Easier for accounting and limits
Other methods (PayPal, prepaid funds)	Availability depends on country and currency; Ads Manager shows the options for your account	Check in Billing and payments → Payment methods

Billing threshold and spending limits

- **Billing threshold:** new accounts start with a low threshold; it rises as you pay reliably. Each time you reach it, Meta charges your card.
- **Account spending limit:** a maximum the whole ad account can spend until you reset it. Useful for beginners and for client accounts.
- **Campaign spending limit:** a cap on one campaign's total spend. Download invoices in Billing and payments for your accountant.

Tax: VAT on foreign digital services

Since **1 January 2026**, Mauritius applies 15% VAT (value added tax) to digital and electronic services supplied by foreign companies, including advertising space. Check how VAT appears on your Meta invoices and ask your accountant how to treat it, especially if your business is VAT-registered.

What does it cost to start?

Meta sets low technical minimums (for impression-based ad sets, about USD 1 a day; more for click or conversion goals). Ads Manager tells you if your budget is too small. A realistic learning budget for a small Mauritian business is often a few hundred rupees a day per ad set, enough to get regular results (Section 22).

> A failed payment stops all your ads, and repeated failures can restrict your account. Add a backup payment method and check that your card has not expired before big campaigns such as Black Friday, the end-of-year holidays or a hotel's winter promotion.

PART B

Strategy and planning

Objectives, campaign structure,
the full funnel, targeting
Mauritius and budget forecasts

SECTION 6

From business goal to campaign objective

The objective is the most important decision in a Meta campaign. It tells the algorithm which people to look for. Choose "Traffic" and Meta finds people who click; choose "Sales" and it looks for people who buy. They are rarely the same people.

The six campaign objectives in Ads Manager

Choose the objective that matches the action you want, not the one that looks cheapest

AWARENESS

Be seen and remembered

Maximum reach or ad recall at a low cost per 1,000 people.

New restaurant opening in Grand Baie

TRAFFIC

Visits to a destination

Link clicks or landing page views to a website, app, Messenger or WhatsApp.

Blog or menu page visits

ENGAGEMENT

Interactions and conversations

Messages, video views, post engagement, Page likes, event responses, calls.

Click-to-WhatsApp chats

LEADS

Contact details from interested people

Instant forms, messaging, calls or website sign-ups.

Gym trial-class sign-ups

APP PROMOTION

Installs and in-app actions

Get people to install your app or act in it.

Food delivery app installs

SALES

Purchases and valuable actions

Website or app purchases, catalogue sales, conversations that lead to sales.

Online cake orders with ROAS

Matching goals to objectives

Business goal	Objective	Conversion location / performance goal	Main KPI (key performance indicator)
Make a new business known in the area	Awareness	Maximise reach or ad recall lift	Reach, CPM, frequency
Get people to read a menu, blog or offer page	Traffic	Website · landing page views	Cost per landing page view
Start WhatsApp conversations	Engagement (or Leads, or Sales)	Message destinations: WhatsApp · conversations	Cost per conversation, then cost per sale
Grow video views for a launch	Engagement	On your ad · ThruPlay or 2-second views	Cost per ThruPlay
Collect contact details for a call back	Leads	Instant forms · leads (or conversion leads)	Cost per lead, lead quality
Bookings or orders on a website	Sales	Website · purchase (or other conversion event)	Cost per purchase, ROAS
App downloads	App promotion	App · installs or app events	Cost per install

Three rules

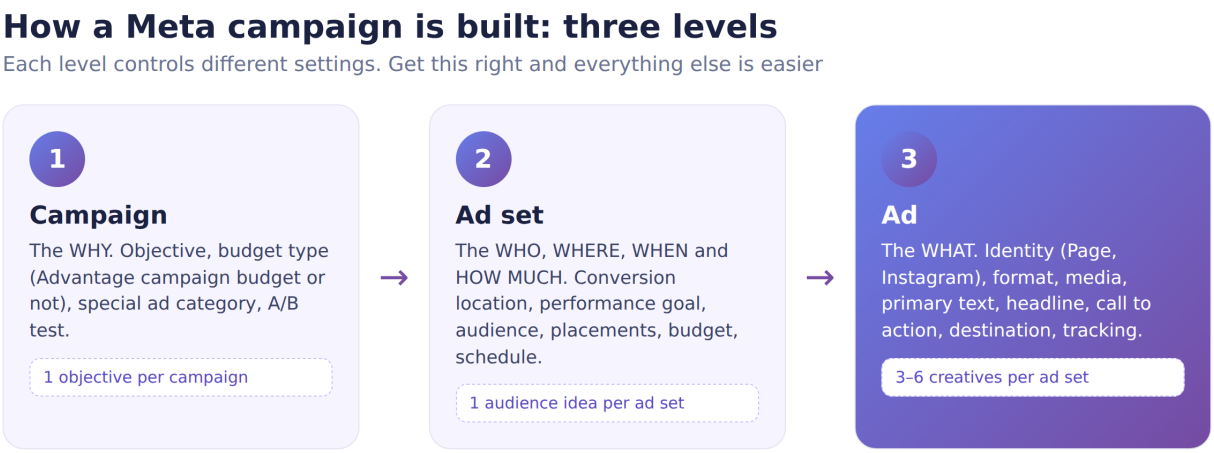
- **Optimise for the action closest to money that you can get often enough.** If you get fewer than about 50 purchases a week, start with a lighter event (add to cart, lead, conversation) and move down the funnel later (Section 22).
- **Don’t judge an objective on another objective’s metric.** An Awareness campaign will have a cheap CPM but few clicks; that is normal.
- **Messaging is possible in several objectives.** Engagement, Leads and Sales can all send people to WhatsApp, with different optimisation (Section 17).

> **Tip:** the ROAS (return on ad spend) and cost per lead targets come from your business numbers, not from Meta. Week 12 shows how to calculate the maximum you can afford per lead or sale from margin and conversion rates.

SECTION 7

Campaign structure and naming

Every Meta campaign has three levels. Each level controls different settings, and your reports follow the same structure.



What you set at each level

Level	Settings	Good practice
Campaign	Objective, special ad category, Advantage campaign budget (on or off), A/B test, campaign spending limit	One objective per campaign; few campaigns
Ad set	Conversion location, performance goal, conversion event, budget and schedule (if not at campaign level), audience, placements, bid strategy, attribution setting	1–3 ad sets per campaign; different audiences, not small variations
Ad	Identity (Page, Instagram), format, media, primary text, headline, description, call-to-action button, destination, tracking (Pixel, URL parameters)	3–6 different creatives per ad set; pause the weak ones

Simple structures that work

Business	Structure
Small shop starting out	1 campaign (Engagement → WhatsApp) · 1 ad set (Mauritius, Advantage+ audience) · 4 ads
Service business with a website	Campaign 1 Leads (instant form) · Campaign 2 Sales/Leads retargeting of website visitors
Online shop	Campaign 1 Advantage+ sales campaign (prospecting) · Campaign 2 retargeting with catalogue ads (optional)
Hotel or guesthouse	Campaign 1 Awareness video in tourist markets · Campaign 2 Sales (bookings) · Campaign 3 Click-to-WhatsApp for local residents

A naming convention

Clear names make reports readable and help anyone take over your account. Agree on one pattern and use it everywhere, with the same spelling as your UTM tags (Week 2).

```
Campaign:  2026-11_LagonBleu_Sales_Bookings_MU-FR-RE
Ad set:    Broad-Adv+_25-65_MU   |   Retarget_Web-30d
Ad:        Reel_PoolSunset_v1    |   Carousel_Rooms_v2    |   UGC_Couple_v1
```

Use the date, business, objective, goal and market for campaigns; the audience for ad sets; the format, concept and version for ads.

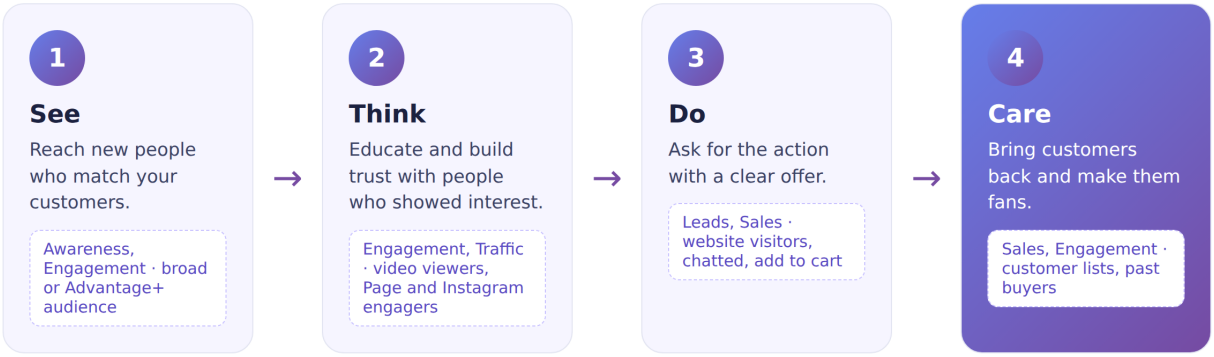
SECTION 8

The full-funnel Meta plan

People rarely buy the first time they see an ad. A good Meta plan speaks to people at each stage of the customer journey you met in Week 1: from strangers to customers to fans.

A full-funnel Meta plan

Different audiences need different messages, objectives and creatives



Prospecting and retargeting

- **Prospecting** means reaching people who don’t know you yet. This is where most of the budget goes, because your warm audiences in Mauritius are small.
- **Retargeting** (also called remarketing) means showing a follow-up message to people who already interacted: website visitors, video viewers, people who messaged you or opened a form.
- **Retention** means bringing customers back: new collections, loyalty offers, events, using your customer list.

A starting budget split (illustrative)

Stage	Share of budget	Example for Rs 30,000 a month
See and Think (prospecting)	60–70%	Rs 20,000: Reels and videos to broad Mauritius audience
Do (retargeting)	20–30%	Rs 7,000: offer and testimonials to visitors and engagers
Care (customers)	5–10%	Rs 3,000: new products to customer list

In a small market the retargeting pools fill up slowly, so the split depends on your traffic. If your retargeting ads reach the same people 8–10 times a week, move budget back to prospecting.

Research your competitors in the Ad Library

The **Meta Ad Library** (facebook.com/ads/library) shows every active ad running on Meta's platforms. It is free and needs no login for commercial ads.

1. Choose the country (Mauritius) and "All ads".
2. Search a competitor's Page name or a keyword ("cake", "gym", "villa").
3. Note their formats, offers, hooks, languages and how long ads have been running. An ad running for months is probably working.
4. Look at the destination: WhatsApp, form or website.
5. Save examples in a "swipe file" for inspiration, then make your own, better version. Never copy.

> **In Mauritius:** search the Ad Library for your category in Mauritius before every new campaign. You will quickly see that most local advertisers use click-to-WhatsApp ads, few use video well, and very few test several creatives. That is your opportunity.

SECTION 9

Targeting Mauritius and tourist markets

Location is the first and most important targeting choice. In Mauritius it is also where many beginners make mistakes.

Location options

Option	When to use it	Example
Country: Mauritius	Most local businesses with island-wide delivery or customers	Online shop, training centre, telecom offer
Region or city	Customers come from one part of the island	Restaurant in Grand Baie targeting the north
Radius around an address (pin)	Shops, gyms, clinics that people visit	10 km around a gym in Quatre Bornes
Rodrigues	Businesses serving Rodrigues; check the location is included or excluded as needed	Airline or ferry offer
Other countries	Tourism, real estate for foreigners, export	Réunion and France for a guesthouse
People living in vs recently in	"People living in or recently in this location" is the default; tourists in Mauritius count as "recently in"	Activities and restaurants targeting visitors on the island

Tourist markets

Mauritius welcomed **1,436,250 tourists in 2025** (+3.9% on 2024). France and Réunion were the top two source markets in the first half of 2025, and India was the fastest-growing market (+33.5% in 2025). For hotels, guesthouses, activity providers and real estate, Meta lets you target these markets directly, in their language.

- Create separate ad sets (or campaigns) per language: French for France and Réunion, English for the UK and South Africa, and German, Italian or Hindi creative where you have it.
- Use the target market's currency in the ad text (EUR, GBP, ZAR or INR) and keep rupees for local ads.
- Time your campaigns with their booking seasons and school holidays, not only with Mauritian dates.
- Target tourists already on the island with "people recently in" Mauritius for restaurants, excursions and spas.

Age, gender and language

With Advantage+ audience, only **location** and **minimum age** are strict limits; maximum age and gender become suggestions (Section 14). Language targeting is rarely needed for Mauritius, because most people use Facebook in English or French; write the ad in the language your customers speak instead. Always respect legal age rules, for example 18+ for alcohol.

> A frequent mistake is to target "Mauritius" for a tourism business that needs foreign guests, or to target the whole world "to get cheap reach". Cheap impressions from the wrong country bring no bookings and pollute your retargeting audiences.

SECTION 10

Budget planning and forecasting

Before launching, estimate what your budget can deliver. A simple forecast based on CPM, CTR (click-through rate) and conversion rate sets realistic expectations and tells you if the plan can reach its goal.

The forecasting chain

Step	Formula	Example (illustrative)
Impressions	budget ÷ CPM × 1,000	Rs 20,000 ÷ Rs 150 × 1,000 = 133,333
Reach	impressions ÷ frequency	133,333 ÷ 2.5 = 53,333 people
Link clicks	impressions × CTR (link)	133,333 × 1.2% = 1,600 clicks
Conversions	clicks × conversion rate	1,600 × 4% = 64 leads
Cost per result	budget ÷ conversions	Rs 20,000 ÷ 64 = Rs 313 per lead
Sales and revenue	leads × close rate × average sale	64 × 25% × Rs 6,000 = Rs 96,000
ROAS	revenue ÷ ad spend	Rs 96,000 ÷ Rs 20,000 = 4.8

Where do the assumptions come from?

- **Your own past campaigns** are the best source. Export the last 3–6 months from Ads Manager.
- **Ads Manager estimates**: when you build an ad set, the right-hand panel shows the estimated audience size and daily results for your budget. Treat them as rough ranges.

- **Industry benchmarks** vary hugely by country, sector and season. Use them only as a sense check, and replace them with your own numbers after the first two weeks.
- **Your website and sales data** (GA4 key events, CRM, WhatsApp labels) give conversion and close rates.

How much budget is enough?

Work backwards from the learning phase: an ad set needs about 50 optimisation events in 7 days to exit learning. If your expected cost per lead is Rs 300, that is roughly Rs 15,000 a week (about Rs 2,100 a day) for one ad set to learn fully on leads. If that is too much, optimise for a more frequent event (conversations, landing page views), combine ad sets, or accept a longer learning period.

> **Rule of thumb:** fewer ad sets with more budget each beat many ad sets with tiny budgets. Rs 1,500 a day in one ad set learns faster than Rs 300 a day in five.

PART C

Build your campaigns

Tracking, step-by-step set-up,
audiences, placements, WhatsApp,
lead and sales campaigns

SECTION 11

Tracking first: the Meta Pixel and events

Install tracking before you spend your first rupee. Without it, Meta cannot optimise for leads or sales, you cannot build website audiences, and you cannot prove results.

What the Pixel is

The **Meta Pixel** is a small piece of JavaScript code on your website. When a visitor does something (views a page, fills in a form, buys), the Pixel sends an **event** to Meta. In Events Manager, the Pixel now sits inside a **dataset**, which can also receive events from the Conversions API, your app and offline sources.

Standard events to know

Event	When it fires	Typical business
PageView	Every page load (automatic with the base code)	All websites
ViewContent	A product, room or service page is viewed	Shops, hotels
Search	Someone uses the site search	Shops, property sites
AddToCart	A product is added to the basket	Online shops
InitiateCheckout	Checkout or booking form starts	Shops, hotels
Lead	A form is submitted (quote, contact, brochure)	Services, training, real estate
CompleteRegistration	A sign-up is completed	Events, webinars, apps
Contact	A click on phone, email or WhatsApp	Local services
Schedule	An appointment is booked	Clinics, salons, gyms
Purchase	An order or booking is paid (send value and currency)	Shops, hotels, ticketing

Three ways to install the Pixel

Method	How	Best for
Partner integration	Events Manager → Connect data → choose WordPress/WooCommerce, Shopify, Wix and follow the steps (often also sets up the Conversions API)	Most small businesses
Google Tag Manager	Add the Pixel base code as a Custom HTML tag on all pages, then event tags on triggers (form submit, thank-you page), as in Week 2	Sites already using GTM
Manual code	Paste the base code in the <head> of every page and add event code where needed	Developers, custom sites

Test your set-up

1. Install the **Meta Pixel Helper** extension in Chrome and open your website: it shows which events fire.
2. In Events Manager, use **Test events**: open your site from the test link and complete a form or a test order.

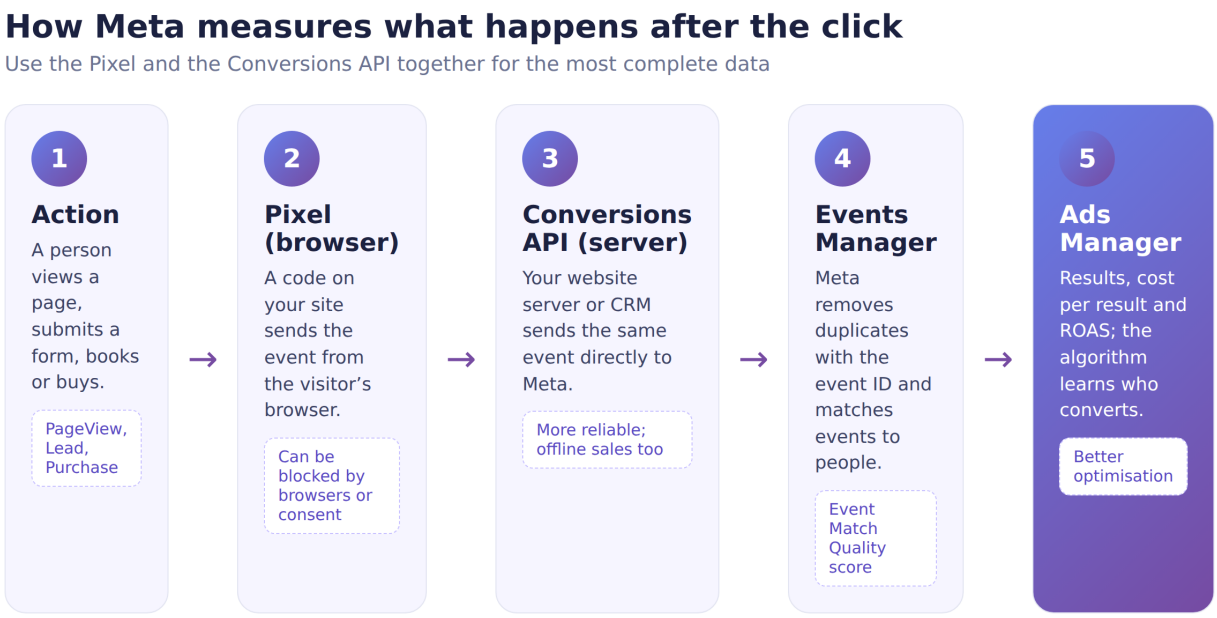
3. Check that a Purchase event sends the right **value** and **currency** (for example 2500 and MUR, or the currency your shop uses).
4. Create **custom conversions** when you cannot add event code, for example "URL contains /thank-you".
5. Compare with GA4 key events (Week 2): the numbers will not match exactly, but they should be in the same range.

> **Tip:** if your business sells mainly through WhatsApp or by phone, you can still track: count conversations started in Ads Manager, label chats as "Paid" in WhatsApp Business, and, for advanced set-ups, send offline sales back to Meta with the Conversions API.

SECTION 12

Conversions API, domains and privacy

Browsers, ad blockers, cookie consent and iPhone privacy settings stop some Pixel events from reaching Meta. The Conversions API fixes much of this by sending events from your server.



The Conversions API (CAPI) in plain English

- The **Pixel** sends events from the visitor's browser. The **Conversions API** sends the same events from your website server, your shop platform or your CRM (customer relationship management system).
- Use **both together** (Meta's recommended "redundant" set-up). Give each event the same **event ID** so Meta counts it only once (deduplication).
- Send customer information such as email and phone number, which is **hashed** (scrambled) before it is used, to help Meta match events to people. Events Manager shows an **Event Match Quality** score out of 10 for each event.
- CAPI can also send **offline events**: a sale closed in the shop or on WhatsApp after a lead from an ad.

How to set it up without a developer

Your website	Easiest route
Shopify	Facebook & Instagram app: choose the "Maximum" data-sharing level
WordPress / WooCommerce	Official Meta plugin, or a tracking plugin with Conversions API support
Other or custom sites	Conversions API Gateway or a partner (for example server-side GTM, Week 11), set up from Events Manager
CRM or booking engine	Check its Meta integration; many send leads and bookings as events

Aggregated Event Measurement and domain verification in 2026

After Apple's iOS 14 privacy changes in 2021, Meta asked advertisers to verify their domain and rank up to 8 events per domain ("Aggregated Event Measurement", AEM). Meta has since removed that manual step: you no longer need to prioritise events or choose a conversion domain when creating ads, and the AEM tab was removed from Events Manager. Meta still processes iOS conversions in an aggregated way in the background.

Domain verification is no longer required for event set-up, but it is still recommended: it proves you own the website and controls who can edit link previews to your domain. Add a DNS (domain name system) TXT record or a meta tag, as shown in Settings → Brand safety → Domains.

Privacy and consent in Mauritius

Tracking and customer lists involve personal data, so the **Data Protection Act 2017** applies. Mention Meta tracking in your privacy policy, use a cookie banner where needed (and always for EU visitors, whose GDPR rules are stricter), and only upload customer lists of people who gave you their details and could expect marketing from you.

SECTION 13

Create a campaign step by step

Here is the full path in Ads Manager for a typical campaign. The screens change often, but the logic stays the same. Meta now opens most campaigns with Advantage+ settings switched on by default (Section 19); you can keep them or adjust them.

Campaign level

1. Open **adsmanager.facebook.com**, check you are in the right ad account (top left) and click **+ Create**.
2. Choose the **objective** (Section 6). Ads Manager may suggest a campaign set-up; keep the default unless you have a reason to change it.
3. Name the campaign with your naming convention (Section 7).
4. Declare a **special ad category** if your ad is about financial products and services, employment, housing, or social issues, elections or politics (Section 27).
5. Decide on **Advantage campaign budget** (budget at campaign level, shared between ad sets) and set a daily or lifetime budget (Section 22).
6. Optionally create an **A/B test** (Section 23).

Ad set level

1. Choose the **conversion location**: website, app, message destinations (WhatsApp, Messenger, Instagram), instant forms, calls, or a combination.

2. Choose the **performance goal** (for example maximise number of conversions, conversations, leads, landing page views or value) and the **conversion event** (Purchase, Lead…) with your dataset.
3. Set the **schedule** (start and end dates) and, if at ad set level, the budget.
4. Define the **audience**: location, minimum age, custom audiences and suggestions (Sections 14–15).
5. Choose **placements**: Advantage+ placements is recommended (Section 16).
6. Check the attribution setting and, rarely, a bid strategy (Sections 22 and 26).

Ad level

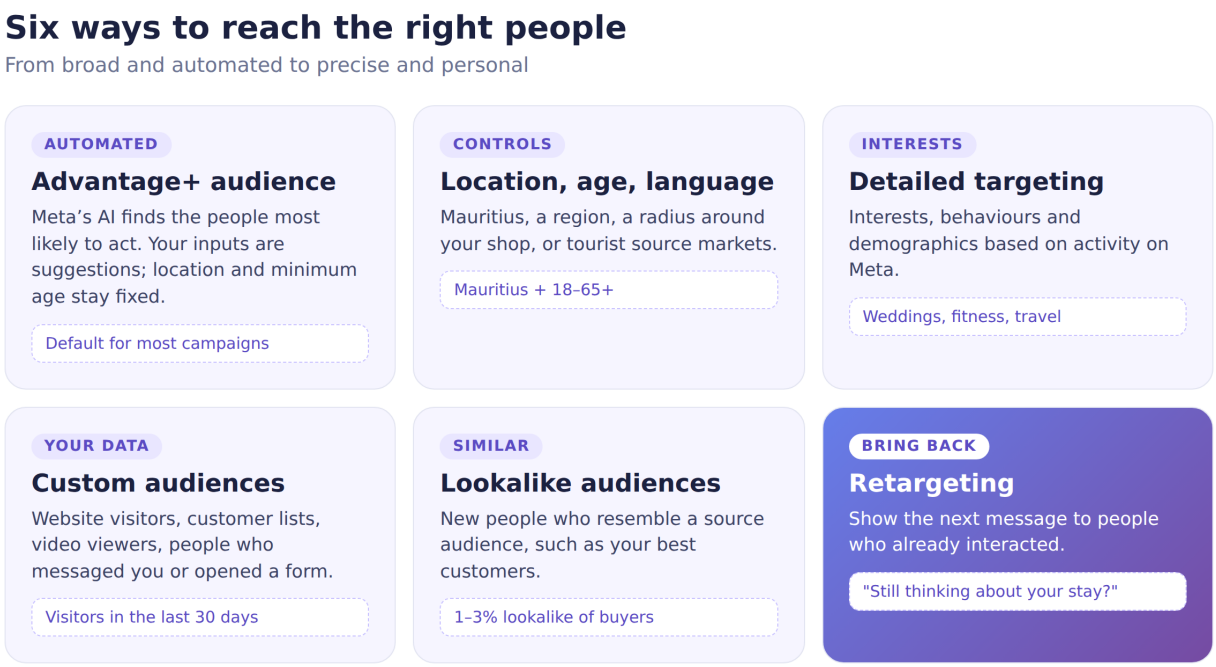
1. Choose the **identity**: your Facebook Page and Instagram account.
2. Choose the **format**: single image or video, carousel, or collection (catalogue).
3. Upload media in the right ratios (9:16 and 4:5, Section 20) and review the preview of each placement.
4. Write **primary text**, **headline** and optional description; add text variations if you want Meta to test them.
5. Choose the **call-to-action** button (Learn more, Book now, Send WhatsApp message, Sign up, Shop now).
6. Add the destination (website URL with UTM parameters, WhatsApp greeting, or instant form).
7. Review **Advantage+ creative** enhancements one by one (Section 21).
8. Check tracking (dataset selected), then **Publish**. Ads go into review, which usually takes less than a day.

> **Tip:** add URL parameters to every website ad so GA4 can show Meta traffic correctly, for example utm_source=facebook&utm_medium=paid_social&utm_campaign={{campaign.name}}. Meta fills in the {{…}} values automatically. Use the same lowercase naming rules as in Week 2.

SECTION 14

Audiences: Advantage+ and detailed targeting

You have two ways to define who sees your ads: let Meta’s AI find people with **Advantage+ audience** (now the default), or set strict rules with the **original audience options**.



Advantage+ audience

With Advantage+ audience, you set **controls** that are strict limits (location, minimum age, excluded custom audiences, languages) and **suggestions** that Meta uses as a starting point but can go beyond (maximum age, gender, detailed targeting, custom audiences). Meta prioritises your suggestions first, then expands if it predicts better results elsewhere.

Use Advantage+ audience when…	Use original audience options when…
You optimise for conversions (leads, purchases, conversations)	You need strict limits, for example a legal age or a specific profession
You have good tracking and enough results	You are testing a very specific hypothesis
You want the simplest set-up	Your product only fits a narrow group (B2B, luxury property)

Detailed targeting

Detailed targeting uses interests, behaviours and demographics based on what people do on Meta's apps: pages they like, ads they click, content they engage with. Examples: "Weddings", "Physical fitness", "Frequent international travellers", "Small business owners", "Parents (with children 0–12 months)".

- Meta has merged or removed many narrow interests since 2022 (especially sensitive topics such as health, religion, politics or sexual orientation).
- Since January 2025, detailed targeting **exclusions** are no longer available: you can exclude custom audiences (for example existing customers), but not interests.
- Several interests in the same box are combined with OR (people who match any of them). Use "Narrow audience" to require two groups at the same time; in a small market this quickly makes audiences too small.
- With conversion objectives, Meta may show your ads to people outside the interests if it predicts better results ("Advantage detailed targeting").

How big should an audience be?

In Mauritius, Meta's estimated audience for the whole country is about 886,000 people on Facebook. Very narrow audiences (fewer than 20,000–50,000 people) get expensive and saturated quickly. For prospecting, start broad (Mauritius, 18+ or 25+, Advantage+ audience) and let your creative do the targeting. Keep narrow audiences for retargeting.

> **In Mauritius:** a wedding planner in Mauritius might target interests "Engagement" and "Weddings" for brides-to-be in Mauritius, plus France and Réunion for destination weddings, in two separate ad sets with different languages and offers.

SECTION 15

Custom audiences, lookalikes and retargeting

Custom audiences are built from people who already know you. They are your most valuable audiences: smaller, warmer and cheaper to convert.

Types of custom audience

Source	Example audience	Use
Website (Pixel)	All visitors last 30 days; viewed /rooms but did not book; purchased last 180 days	Retargeting, exclusions
Customer list	Emails and phone numbers of past customers (hashed on upload)	Retention, lookalike source, exclusion
Video	People who watched 50% or more of your Reels in the last 60 days	Warm prospecting, retargeting
Instagram account / Facebook Page	People who engaged with your profile or posts in 90 days	Retargeting
Lead form	People who opened but did not submit your instant form	Retargeting with a reminder
Messaging	People who messaged your Page or WhatsApp	Follow-up offers
App activity, offline events, events, shopping	Depending on your set-up	Advanced

Create a website custom audience

1. Ads Manager → menu → **Audiences** → Create audience → **Custom audience**.
2. Choose **Website** and select your dataset (Pixel).
3. Choose the rule: all visitors, visitors of specific pages, or people who triggered an event (for example AddToCart).
4. Set the retention period (up to 180 days for website audiences) and name it clearly: "Web – Rooms viewed – 30d".
5. Wait until it has enough people; very small audiences may not deliver.

Lookalike audiences

A **lookalike audience** finds new people who resemble a source audience (your customers, your best leads, your video viewers). You choose the country and a size from 1% (most similar) to 10% (broader). In Mauritius, 1% of the Facebook ad audience is only a few thousand people, so 1–5% is common; for tourist markets like France, 1% is already large.

- Use the **best quality** source: buyers or qualified leads, at least a few hundred people (Meta's technical minimum is 100 people in one country).
- With Advantage+ audience, lookalikes and custom audiences become suggestions that guide the AI.
- Lookalikes are not available for some special ad categories.

Retargeting ideas that work

Who	Message	Window
Viewed a product or room, no purchase	The item again, reviews, a reason to book now	7–30 days
Watched 50% of a video	The next step: offer, testimonial, how it works	30–60 days
Opened the form but did not submit	Shorter form or WhatsApp alternative	14 days
Customers	Upsell, new collection, referral offer; exclude from acquisition ads	30–365 days

> Exclude recent buyers from "Buy now" ads. Nothing annoys a customer more than an ad offering 20% off something they bought at full price yesterday.

SECTION 16

Placements: where your ads appear

A placement is a place where your ad can be shown: the Facebook feed, Instagram Stories, Reels, Messenger, WhatsApp and more. You can let Meta choose (Advantage+ placements) or pick them yourself (manual placements).

Placement group	Where	Best creative
Feeds	Facebook Feed, Instagram Feed and profile feed, Marketplace, video feeds, right column (desktop), Threads feed	4:5 image or video, carousel
Stories and Status	Facebook and Instagram Stories, Messenger Stories, WhatsApp Status (Updates tab)	9:16 full-screen video or image
Reels	Facebook and Instagram Reels, ads on Facebook Reels (overlays)	9:16 video with sound, native style
In-stream video	Facebook in-stream (before or during videos), Instagram profile reels	Video with message in the first seconds
Search results	Facebook and Instagram search results	Image or video with clear offer
Messages	Messenger inbox and sponsored messages	Simple image, conversation starter
Apps and sites	Audience Network: partner mobile apps outside Meta	Square or vertical video, image
Instagram Explore	Explore grid and Explore home	Strong visual

Advantage+ placements or manual?

Meta recommends **Advantage+ placements**: your budget goes where results are cheapest, and more placements usually means lower costs. Use manual placements only for a clear reason:

- Your creative only works in one format (for example a 9:16 video made for Reels and Stories).
- Brand safety: you prefer to avoid Audience Network or in-stream video for a premium brand.
- Audience Network brings many cheap clicks but poor leads for your account (check the placement breakdown, Section 25).
- You are running an A/B test of placements.

Newer placements to know in 2026

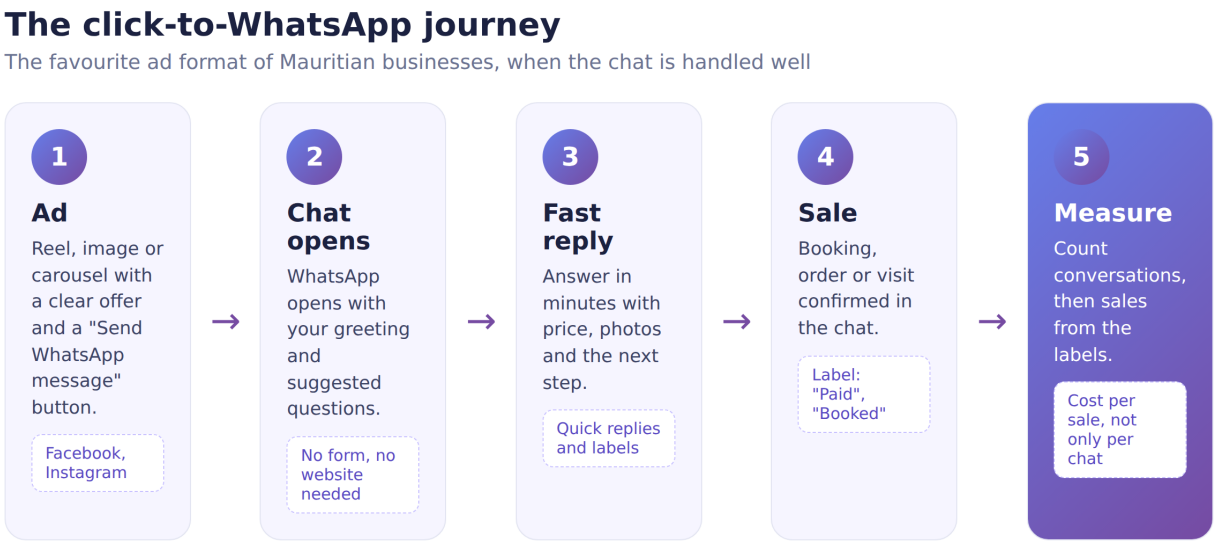
- **Threads**: Meta began rolling out Threads ads worldwide from late January 2026. Threads is included with Advantage+ placements where available.
- **WhatsApp Status**: ads in the Updates tab of WhatsApp, separate from personal chats, which stay end-to-end encrypted.
- **Reels**: the fastest-growing inventory; good vertical video gives you access to it at a lower cost.

> **Tip:** even with Advantage+ placements, upload creatives in several ratios (or use the crop tool for each placement group) so your ad looks native everywhere. A horizontal video with black bars in Stories wastes money.

SECTION 17

Click-to-WhatsApp and messaging ads

In Mauritius, many customers prefer to ask questions and order by WhatsApp rather than fill in a form or buy on a website. Click-to-WhatsApp ads are often the best-performing ad type for local SMEs, as long as someone answers the chats quickly.



Set it up

1. Connect your WhatsApp Business number to your Facebook Page (Page settings → Linked accounts → WhatsApp) and to your business portfolio. You will receive a confirmation code by WhatsApp.

2. In Ads Manager, choose the objective: **Engagement** (maximise conversations, the simplest), **Leads** (conversations with people likely to share details) or **Sales** (conversations likely to purchase; needs good signals).
3. At ad set level, set the conversion location to **Message destinations** and tick **WhatsApp** (you can also add Messenger and Instagram Direct and let Meta choose).
4. Create the ad with the button **Send WhatsApp message**.
5. Write the **message template**: a greeting and 3–5 suggested questions people can tap ("What are your prices?", "Do you deliver to Curepipe?", "Is Saturday available?").
6. Publish, then make sure the team is ready to reply before the ads go live.

Make chats turn into sales

Practice	How
Reply in minutes	Fast answers convert better; set business hours and an away message for nights
Quick replies	Saved answers for prices, delivery, opening hours, location (type "/" in WhatsApp Business)
Catalogue	Add products or room types to your WhatsApp Business catalogue and share them in the chat
Labels	Label every chat: "New lead – Ad", "Quote sent", "Paid", "Lost"; count them weekly
Follow up	Send a polite reminder after 24 hours if the person did not reply
Hand-over	Use WhatsApp Business on several phones (linked devices), or a team inbox tool on the WhatsApp Business Platform

Measure what matters

Ads Manager reports **messaging conversations started** and **cost per messaging conversation started**. That is only half the story. Each week, count the chats labelled "Paid" and calculate the **cost per sale** (spend ÷ sales) and the **conversation-to-sale rate** (sales ÷ conversations).

For businesses on the **WhatsApp Business Platform** (the API, used with a provider), conversations that start from a click-to-WhatsApp ad open a 72-hour free entry window in which business messages are free. On the free WhatsApp Business app there is no per-message charge anyway.

> **In Mauritius:** a cake shop, a car rental company or a tuition centre can run a click-to-WhatsApp campaign with a few hundred rupees a day. The difference between Rs 800 per sale and Rs 3,000 per sale is usually not the ad: it is how fast and how well the chats are answered.

SECTION 18

Lead ads with instant forms

Lead ads open a form inside Facebook or Instagram, pre-filled with the person’s name, email and phone number. They are easy to complete on a phone, so they bring many leads, but quality needs care.

Create an instant form

1. Choose the **Leads** objective and the conversion location **Instant forms**.
2. At ad level, create a new form. Choose the form type: **More volume** (quick to submit) or **Higher intent** (adds a review step so people confirm their details).
3. Add an intro: headline, image and 2–3 lines on what people get.
4. Ask only the questions you need: name, phone (WhatsApp), email, plus 1–2 qualifying questions ("When do you plan your wedding?", "Which area do you live in?"). Multiple-choice questions filter better than free text.
5. Add your **privacy policy** link (required) and any custom consent checkbox.
6. Write a **completion screen** with the next step: "We will WhatsApp you within 2 hours", plus a button to call, WhatsApp or visit the website.

Getting leads out of Meta quickly

Option	How	Good for
Meta Business Suite → Leads Center	See, assign and download leads; update their stage	Small businesses
CSV download	From the form library or Leads Center	Occasional use only (leads go cold)
CRM integration	Connect a CRM (HubSpot, Zoho, Brevo…) or an automation tool to receive leads instantly	Anyone with daily leads
Notifications	Email or WhatsApp alert to the sales person for each new lead	Fast response

Improving lead quality

- Use the **Higher intent** form type and one or two qualifying questions.
- Say the price range or conditions in the ad: people who submit already accept them.
- Call or message every lead within the hour. Leads go cold quickly.
- Mark which leads became customers (in Leads Center or your CRM) and, when possible, send this back to Meta so you can optimise for **conversion leads** (leads more likely to convert) rather than any lead.
- Compare cost per **qualified** lead and cost per customer, not only cost per lead.

> **Tip:** for many Mauritian audiences, a click-to-WhatsApp ad brings fewer but warmer leads than an instant form. Test both (Section 23) and compare the cost per customer.

SECTION 19

Sales campaigns, catalogues and Advantage+

Sales campaigns optimise for purchases or other valuable actions on your website, app or in chats. Since 2025, Meta has made Advantage+ the default way to run Sales, Leads and App campaigns.

What "Advantage+" means

Advantage+ is Meta’s name for its AI automation. You will see it in many places:

Feature	Level	What it does
Advantage campaign budget	Campaign	Shares one budget between ad sets and moves money to the best performers
Advantage+ audience	Ad set	Finds people beyond your suggestions (Section 14)
Advantage+ placements	Ad set	Shows ads in all eligible placements (Section 16)
Advantage+ creative	Ad	Automatic creative enhancements and variations (Section 21)
Advantage+ catalogue ads	Ad	Shows each person the products from your catalogue they are most likely to want

Advantage+ sales, leads and app campaigns

In 2025 Meta renamed **Advantage+ shopping campaigns** to **Advantage+ sales campaigns** and made Advantage+ the default set-up for Sales, Leads and App promotion campaigns. A campaign has "Advantage+ on" when its three levers are on: Advantage campaign budget, Advantage+ audience and Advantage+ placements. If you override some settings (for example a strict age range), Ads Manager shows that Advantage+ is switched off for that campaign, but you can still run it.

Advantage+ on (default)	Manual settings
Fast to set up, fewer decisions	More control over who sees ads
Usually lower cost per result when tracking is good	Useful for strict audiences or tests
Needs good creative variety and clean conversion data	Needs more skill and more budget to test
Less insight into why it works	Clearer learning per audience

Catalogues for online shops

1. Create a **catalogue** in Commerce Manager, or sync it from Shopify or WooCommerce: product ID, title, description, price, image, link, availability.
2. Connect the catalogue to your dataset so the Pixel’s ViewContent, AddToCart and Purchase events include the product ID.
3. Create a Sales campaign with **Advantage+ catalogue ads**: Meta shows each person the products they viewed or are likely to want.
4. Add **product sets** (for example "Birthday cakes", "Under Rs 1,500") and test overlays such as price or free delivery.

In Mauritius: if you don’t have an online shop, you can still run Sales campaigns that optimise for conversations likely to lead to a purchase, or you can use your WhatsApp Business catalogue in the chat. Many Mauritian SMEs start there and add a website shop later (Week 16, e-commerce).

PART D

Creative and optimisation

Ads that stop the scroll, AI tools,
budgets, the learning phase,
A/B tests and fixing campaigns

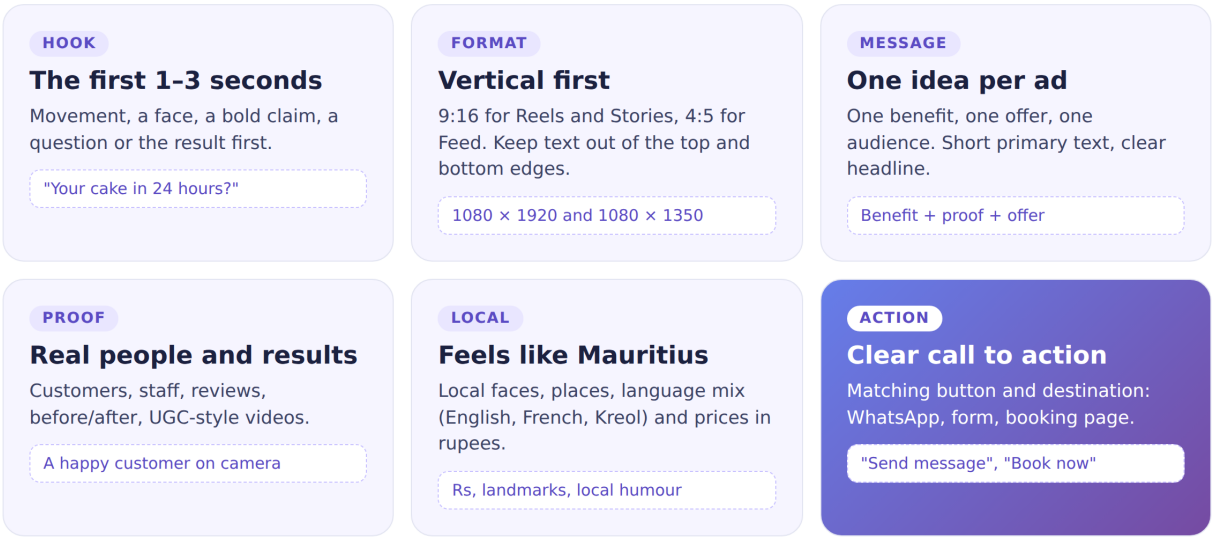
SECTION 20

Creative that performs

With AI doing most of the targeting, your creative (the image or video, the text and the offer) has become the strongest lever you control. It decides who stops, who clicks and who Meta shows the ad to next.

Anatomy of a Meta ad that stops the scroll

Creative is now the strongest lever you control: the algorithm uses it to find the right people



Formats and sizes

Format	Recommended size	Use it for
Vertical video or image	9:16 (1080 × 1920 px)	Reels, Stories, WhatsApp Status
Feed video or image	4:5 (1080 × 1350 px)	Facebook and Instagram feeds
Square	1:1 (1080 × 1080 px)	Carousel cards, right column, flexible use
Carousel	2–10 cards, 1:1 or 4:5	Several products, rooms, steps or reviews
Collection / catalogue	Cover image or video + product grid	Online shops

In 9:16 creatives, keep text and logos away from the top and bottom (roughly the top 14% and bottom 20–35%) where profile names, captions and buttons appear. Ads Manager shows these "safe zones" in the preview.

Writing the text

Element	Advice	Example
Primary text	The first line is visible before "…more": put the hook and benefit there. Short (1–3 lines) for most ads	"Birthday tomorrow? We bake and deliver your cake in 24 h."
Headline	5–8 words, the offer or benefit	Custom cakes from Rs 1,200
Description	Optional; often not shown	Delivered in Plaines Wilhems
Call to action button	Match the next step	Send WhatsApp message

Hooks that work

- **Result first:** show the finished cake, the sea view, the transformation in the first second.
- **Question:** "Still searching for a wedding venue in the north?"
- **Local surprise:** a familiar place, accent or Kreol phrase that says "this is for you".
- **Problem:** "Your AC smells bad? Here's why."
- **Person on camera:** the owner, a staff member or a customer speaking directly to the viewer.

UGC and creator-style ads

UGC (user-generated content) means content made by customers, or videos made to look like it: a person filming on a phone, talking naturally about a product. It often performs better than polished studio ads because it looks like the posts around it. Ask happy customers for short videos (with written permission), work with local creators (Week 5, Section 21), and always disclose paid partnerships.

Build a creative mix, not one ad

Meta's delivery system now finds different people for different creatives, so an ad set with 3–6 **really different** concepts (not the same image in three colours) usually beats one "perfect" ad. Mix formats (Reel, image, carousel), angles (price, quality, emotion, proof) and people.

> **Tip:** for videos, add the video columns in Ads Manager (3-second video plays, ThruPlays, video plays at 25%, 50%, 75% and 100%). Many impressions but few 3-second plays means a weak hook; many 3-second plays but few people reaching 50% means the middle is too slow.

SECTION 21

Advantage+ creative and AI tools

Meta offers more and more generative AI (artificial intelligence that creates new text, images or video) inside Ads Manager. Used well, it saves time and finds new variations; used blindly, it can produce ads that look fake or say things you never approved.

Advantage+ creative enhancements

When you create an ad, Ads Manager offers a list of **creative enhancements**. Depending on your account and format, they can include:

- **Text improvements and text variations:** Meta rewrites or tests different versions of your primary text and headline.
- **Visual touch-ups and image expansion:** automatic cropping, brightness and filling an image to fit 9:16 or 4:5.
- **Generated backgrounds and image variations:** new backgrounds or versions of a product photo.
- **Image animation and video generation:** turning still images into short videos, adding music.
- **Adding overlays and site links:** showing a price, a product or extra links from your website.
- **Translations:** versions of your ad in other languages, useful for tourist markets.

How to use them safely

1. Open the list of enhancements for each new ad and **review each one**: switch off those that don't suit your brand.
2. Preview every placement: check spelling, prices, names of places and the meaning of translated text (French and Kreol nuances matter).
3. Never let AI invent claims, prices, reviews or results.
4. Keep human faces, real staff and real customers when trust matters (food, health, education).
5. Compare performance with and without enhancements in an A/B test (Section 23).

AI tools outside Ads Manager

Task	Tools (examples)	Watch out for
Ideas, hooks and text variations	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Meta AI	Generic copy: add your local details and proof
Images and resizing	Canva (Magic Resize, Magic Edit), Adobe Express, Meta's tools	Unrealistic food or rooms; customer disappointment
Video editing and subtitles	CapCut, Edits (Instagram), Canva video	Music rights: use licensed libraries
Translation	DeepL, AI assistants	Check with a native speaker for ads in French or German

Disclosure

Meta labels some content made or edited with its AI tools, and requires advertisers to disclose digitally created or altered content in ads about social issues, elections or politics. For all ads, be honest: if a photo is a render or AI-generated, don't present it as a real room or real food.

In Mauritius: Week 13 covers AI in marketing in more depth. For Meta ads, the winning combination in Mauritius is usually real, local footage (phone video is fine) with AI helping on variations, subtitles, resizing and translations.

SECTION 22

Budgets, bidding and the learning phase

How you set and change budgets affects results as much as how much you spend.

Daily or lifetime budget?

	Daily budget	Lifetime budget
What it is	Average amount per day; on some days Meta may spend up to 75% more, but no more than 7 × the daily budget in a calendar week	Total for the whole flight; Meta paces it between start and end dates
Best for	Always-on campaigns	Events, launches, promotions with an end date
Extras	Simple to scale up or down	Allows ad scheduling (dayparting), for example only 08:00–21:00

Advantage campaign budget

With **Advantage campaign budget** (formerly CBO, campaign budget optimisation) you set one budget for the campaign and Meta shares it between ad sets, giving more to the ones with the best results. Without it, each ad set has its own budget (ABO, ad set budget optimisation). Use Advantage campaign budget for most campaigns; use ad set budgets when you need to force spend on one audience or market, for example a fixed amount for Réunion and a fixed amount for France.

Bid strategies

Strategy	What it does	When to use it
Highest volume (default)	Gets the most results for your budget	Most campaigns, especially beginners
Cost per result goal	Tries to keep the average cost around your target	You know your affordable cost per lead or sale
ROAS goal	Tries to reach a minimum return on ad spend (value-based)	Online shops sending purchase values
Highest value	Gets the most purchase value for your budget	Shops with varied basket sizes
Bid cap	Sets a maximum bid in each auction	Advanced advertisers only

Budgets and the learning phase

Give the algorithm enough results to learn, then change things slowly



The learning phase

Every new ad set, and every ad set after a **significant edit**, goes through a **learning phase**. Meta needs about **50 optimisation events within 7 days** to stabilise delivery. During learning, results are less stable and usually more expensive. If an ad set cannot get enough events, Ads Manager shows **"Learning limited"**.

- **Significant edits** that restart learning include changing targeting, creative, the optimisation event, the bid strategy, adding a new ad, a large budget change, or pausing for 7 days or more.
- **Fix "Learning limited"** by combining ad sets, broadening the audience, raising the budget, or choosing a more frequent optimisation event.
- **Scale gradually:** raise budgets by about 20% every few days, or duplicate a winning ad set with a larger budget.
- **Be patient:** judge an ad set after 7 days or after about 50 results, not after one bad day.

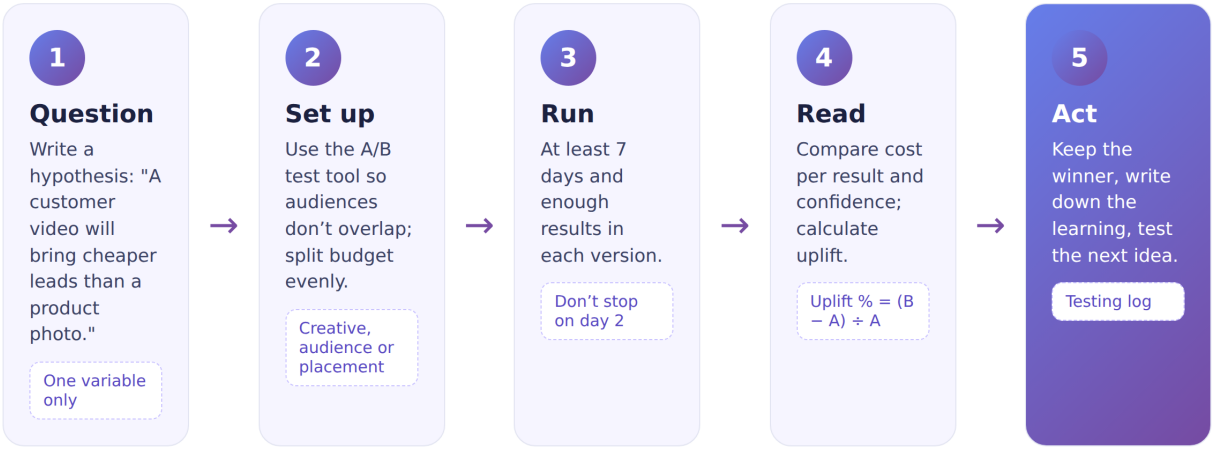
SECTION 23

A/B testing

An A/B test compares two versions that differ in one thing only, to learn what works better. On Meta, the A/B test tool splits the audience so the same person doesn't see both versions.

How to run a clean A/B test

Change one thing, keep everything else the same, decide on the business metric



What to test (in this order)

Variable	Example test	Why
Creative concept	Customer testimonial video vs product photo	Biggest impact on results
Offer	Free delivery vs 10% off	Changes the reason to act
Destination	Click-to-WhatsApp vs instant form	Changes lead quality and cost per customer
Audience	Advantage+ audience vs interest-based	Shows whether manual targeting adds value
Placements	Advantage+ vs Reels and Stories only	Checks a hypothesis about formats
Text	Short vs long primary text	Smaller impact; test later

Set up an A/B test in Ads Manager

1. Select an existing campaign or ad set and click **A/B test** (or toggle "Create A/B test" when creating a campaign).
2. Duplicate it and change **one** variable in the copy.
3. Choose the key metric (cost per result, cost per lead, cost per purchase) and the test length (at least 7 days; Meta allows up to 30).
4. Give both versions the same budget, and enough for each to get results.
5. Read the result in the Experiments section: Meta shows the winner and how confident it is that the result would repeat.

Calculate the uplift

Uplift % = (result of B − result of A) ÷ result of A × 100. For costs, a lower number is better: if version A costs Rs 400 per lead and version B Rs 300, B's cost per lead is (300 − 400) ÷ 400 = −25%, i.e. 25% cheaper. For conversion rates, higher is better: if A converts at 2.0% and B at 2.6%, the uplift is (2.6 − 2.0) ÷ 2.0 = +30%.

> Small numbers lie. If version A has 6 leads and version B has 9, the difference may be pure chance. Wait for enough results (dozens per version, ideally), or use Meta's confidence level, before you declare a winner. Write every test and its result in a testing log.

SECTION 24

Optimising live campaigns

Once a campaign is out of learning, a short weekly routine keeps it healthy. Diagnose problems from the top of the funnel (are people seeing the ad?) to the bottom (are they buying?).

The weekly routine (30 minutes)

1. Check delivery: any ads rejected, ad sets "Learning limited", payment issues?
2. Compare cost per result with your target and with last week.
3. Look at breakdowns (age, placement, region) for big differences, but don’t over-react to small numbers.
4. Check frequency and CTR trends for creative fatigue.
5. Pause clear losers, add 1–2 new creatives to ad sets that need fresh material.
6. Check the business numbers: leads called, chats answered, sales closed.

Diagnose the problem

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
High CPM	Small or competitive audience, low ad quality, high season (December, Black Friday)	Broaden audience, improve creative, plan budgets for peaks
Low CTR (link)	Weak hook or offer, wrong audience, creative fatigue	Test new hooks and concepts, clearer offer
Good CTR but few conversions	Slow or confusing landing page, price surprise, broken form or tracking	Check page speed and mobile layout (Week 2), test tracking, match ad and page
Many leads, few customers	Form too easy, wrong promise, slow follow-up	Higher intent form, qualifying questions, faster calls
Cost rising week after week	Creative fatigue, frequency too high, audience saturated	New creatives, broader audience, rest the campaign
Many chats, few sales	Slow replies, no prices, no follow-up	Reply faster, quick replies, labels, follow-up

Creative fatigue in a small market

In Mauritius, the same people see your ads again and again. When frequency rises (for example above 3–4 in a week for prospecting) and CTR falls, the audience is tired of the ad. Plan to refresh creatives every 2–4 weeks for always-on campaigns, and keep a bank of new photos and videos ready.

> **Tip:** use Ads Manager’s rules (Automated rules) to get an alert or pause an ad when, for example, cost per lead is above Rs 500 after Rs 3,000 of spend. Start with alerts rather than automatic changes.

PART E

Measure and govern

Ads Manager metrics, attribution, reporting, ad policies and special ad categories

SECTION 25

Ads Manager metrics and formulas

Ads Manager can show hundreds of columns. You need about a dozen. Learn what each one means and how it is calculated, so you can check the numbers and explain them to a manager or client.

The essential columns

Metric	What it means	Formula
Amount spent	What you spent in the period	–
Reach	Number of people (Accounts Center accounts) who saw the ad at least once	–
Impressions	Number of times the ad was shown	–
Frequency	Average number of times each person saw the ad	impressions ÷ reach
CPM	Cost per 1,000 impressions	spend ÷ impressions × 1,000
Link clicks	Clicks that go to the destination (website, WhatsApp, form)	–
CTR (link click-through rate)	Share of impressions that led to a link click	link clicks ÷ impressions × 100
CPC (cost per link click)	Average cost of one link click	spend ÷ link clicks
Results	The number of the result you optimised for (leads, purchases, conversations…)	–
Cost per result	Average cost of one result	spend ÷ results
Conversion rate	Share of clicks that became results (calculate it yourself)	results ÷ link clicks × 100
Purchase ROAS	Revenue generated per rupee spent	purchase value ÷ spend

"CTR (all)" and "Clicks (all)" include clicks on the profile name, "See more", likes and photo expansions. For performance, use the **link** versions. Organic insights now use "Views" in many places; Ads Manager reports Impressions and Reach.

A worked example (illustrative)

Data	Value	Calculation	Result
Spend	Rs 12,000	CPM = 12,000 ÷ 80,000 × 1,000	Rs 150
Reach	32,000	Frequency = 80,000 ÷ 32,000	2.5
Impressions	80,000	CTR = 960 ÷ 80,000 × 100	1.2%
Link clicks	960	CPC = 12,000 ÷ 960	Rs 12.50
Leads	48	Cost per lead = 12,000 ÷ 48	Rs 250
Sales value from leads	Rs 60,000	ROAS = 60,000 ÷ 12,000	5.0 (or 500%)

Customise your columns

1. In Ads Manager, click **Columns → Customise columns**.
2. Tick: Results, Cost per result, Amount spent, Reach, Impressions, Frequency, CPM, Link clicks, CTR (link click-through rate), CPC (cost per link click), and the conversions you use (Leads, Messaging conversations started, Purchases, Purchase ROAS).

3. Save it as a preset, for example "Weekly review".
4. Use **Breakdown** (by age, gender, placement, region, time) to see where results come from.

Ad relevance diagnostics

For ads with enough impressions, Ads Manager shows three rankings compared with ads competing for the same audience: **Quality ranking**, **Engagement rate ranking** and **Conversion rate ranking** (below average, average, above average). They are not used in the auction directly; they help you see whether the creative, the hook or the landing page is the weak point.

SECTION 26

Attribution and reporting

Attribution is how a conversion is credited to an ad. It explains why Meta, GA4 and your sales records never show exactly the same numbers.

Meta’s attribution windows in 2026

Each ad set has an **attribution setting**, the time window in which a conversion is credited to the ad after someone interacts with it. In March 2026 Meta changed the definitions to make them stricter and clearer:

Type	What counts	Window
Click-through	A **link click** on the ad (to a website, app, form or chat), then a conversion	1 day or 7 days
Engage-through	A non-link engagement (like, share, save, comment, profile visit) or a video view of at least 5 seconds, then a conversion	1 day
View-through	The ad was seen but not clicked, then a conversion	1 day

For website conversion campaigns the default is **7-day click-through, 1-day engage-through and 1-day view-through**. Before this change, likes and other non-link clicks counted as "click-through", so click-through numbers dropped for many advertisers in 2026 even though actual performance did not change.

Why platforms disagree

Meta Ads Manager	GA4 (Week 2)
Credits conversions to Meta ads, including after a view or engagement	Data-driven attribution across all channels; mostly based on clicks and sessions
Reports conversions on the date of the ad interaction (by default)	Reports conversions on the date they happened
Uses modelled data where tracking is blocked	Only sees what its tag recorded and consented to
Cannot see Google Ads, email or organic search	Sees all channels but not ad views

Neither is "the truth". Use Meta’s numbers to optimise inside Meta, GA4 to compare channels, and your actual sales (till, booking system, WhatsApp labels) as the final judge. Week 12 shows how to work out true ROAS and incremental results.

A simple monthly Meta report

Section	Content
1. Summary	Spend, results, cost per result and ROAS vs target, in three sentences
2. By campaign	Objective, spend, results, cost per result, trend vs last month
3. Best and worst ads	Top 3 and bottom 3 creatives with a reason
4. Audience and placement insights	What the breakdowns show
5. Business results	Leads called, chats converted, sales value, cost per customer
6. Tests and learnings	A/B tests run and what was learned
7. Next month	Budget, new creatives, tests, with owners and dates

In Ads Manager, use **Reports** (Ads Reporting) to build and schedule a custom report by email, or export to a spreadsheet and build a Data Studio dashboard (Week 18).

SECTION 27

Ad policies, special categories and transparency

Every ad is reviewed against Meta’s Advertising Standards before it runs, and can be reviewed again later. Knowing the rules saves you from rejected ads and, worse, restricted accounts.

Common reasons for rejection

Problem	Example	Fix
Personal attributes	"Are you overweight?", "Struggling with debt?"	Talk about the product, not the person: "Our 8-week fitness programme"
Unrealistic claims	"Lose 10 kg in a week", "Guaranteed income"	Realistic, provable claims
Restricted content	Alcohol, dating, gambling, weight loss, financial services	Follow the specific policy (age targeting, authorisation, disclaimers)
Misleading or broken landing page	Page down, different offer, pop-ups everywhere	Working page that matches the ad
Sensational or before/after images	Close-up of body parts, shocking images	Neutral, respectful visuals
Intellectual property	Using a brand logo, music or film clip without rights	Your own or licensed content

If an ad is rejected, read the reason in Account Quality, fix the ad and resubmit, or request a review if you think the decision is wrong. Don’t create new accounts to get around restrictions: that leads to permanent bans.

Special ad categories

Ads in these categories must be declared at campaign level. They have limited targeting to prevent discrimination: age, gender and postcode targeting, many detailed targeting options and lookalikes are restricted or unavailable.

Category	Examples in Mauritius
Financial products and services (replaced "Credit" in 2025)	Bank loans, credit cards, insurance, leasing, investment products
Employment	Job vacancies, recruitment campaigns, internships
Housing	Property for sale or rent, real estate agents, home loans
Social issues, elections or politics	Political parties, campaigns on public debates; requires advertiser authorisation and a "Paid for by" disclaimer

Transparency and the Ad Library

All active ads are visible in the Meta Ad Library, with the Page's history and name changes. Political and social issue ads stay in the library for seven years with spend and reach data. Assume that every ad you run is public and will be seen by competitors and journalists.

Protect the account

- Two admins with two-factor authentication on the business portfolio and ad account.
- Check **Account Quality** (business.facebook.com/accountquality) monthly for warnings.
- Don't click "Meta support" messages asking you to log in: they are phishing (Week 5, Section 26).
- Keep invoices and payment details up to date; remove people who leave the business.

PART F

Put it to work

A case study, your Meta Launch Plan, templates, checklists and glossary

SECTION 28

Case study: a guesthouse’s first Meta plan

"Lagon Bleu" is a fictional 12-room guesthouse in Trou aux Biches. It sells through booking platforms, its own website (with a booking engine) and WhatsApp. The owner had only boosted posts, spending about Rs 15,000 a month with no idea of the results. All numbers below are illustrative.

1. Starting point

- Boosted posts targeting "Mauritius + France", 18–65, mixed languages, no Pixel on the website.
- One admin (a former employee), no business portfolio; the ad account was in his personal profile.
- About 60% of bookings through booking platforms, which charge commission; the goal is more direct bookings.

2. Foundations (week 1)

- Created a business portfolio; moved the Page, Instagram, WhatsApp number and a new ad account (EUR, Indian/Mauritius time zone) into it; two admins with 2FA.
- Installed the Pixel and Conversions API through the booking engine’s Meta integration: ViewContent (room page), InitiateCheckout, Purchase with value.
- Verified the domain, added UTM parameters to all website ads, and created WhatsApp labels: "Ad lead", "Quote sent", "Booked".

3. The Meta Launch Plan

	Campaign 1: Discover	Campaign 2: Book direct	Campaign 3: Local getaways
Objective	Engagement (ThruPlay video views)	Sales (Purchase, website)	Engagement → WhatsApp conversations
Audience	France and Réunion, 25–65, Advantage+ audience, interest suggestions: travel to Mauritius, beach holidays	Website visitors 30 days, video viewers 50% (60 days), lookalike 1% of guests (France)	Mauritius, 25+, Advantage+ audience
Placements	Advantage+ (mainly Reels and Stories)	Advantage+	Advantage+
Creatives	3 Reels in French: sunset from the room, the snorkelling spot, the owner’s welcome	Carousel of rooms, guest review video, "Book direct: free airport transfer"	"Weekend package Rs 9,500 for two", 2 images and 1 Reel in English and Kreol
Budget	Rs 10,000 / month	Rs 14,000 / month	Rs 6,000 / month

4. A/B test

In Campaign 3, the owner tested two creatives for one month: A = photo of the room with price, B = a 20-second phone video of a couple arriving. Results: A cost Rs 140 per conversation (21 conversations, 3 bookings), B cost Rs 95 per conversation (32 conversations, 6 bookings). B’s cost per conversation was (95 − 140) ÷ 140 = 32% lower, and it brought twice as many bookings. The video became the main creative.

5. Results after three months (illustrative)

KPI	Before	Month 3
Monthly Meta spend	Rs 15,000	Rs 30,000
Direct bookings attributed to Meta (website + WhatsApp)	Unknown	22 bookings
Revenue from those bookings	Unknown	Rs 396,000
ROAS (revenue ÷ spend)	Unknown	13.2
Cost per direct booking	Unknown	Rs 1,364
Share of bookings via booking platforms	About 60%	About 48%

> **The lesson:** the budget doubled, but the real change was structure: tracking first, one objective per campaign, different messages for tourists and residents, and WhatsApp chats handled and labelled like a sales pipeline.

SECTION 29

Exercises and your Meta Launch Plan

Your Week 8 deliverable is a **Meta Launch Plan**: a multi-campaign Meta strategy with audience targeting and creative variations. Work on a real business: your own, your employer's or one you know well. You don't need to spend money; if you can, a small test budget of Rs 1,000–2,000 teaches a lot.

Exercise A · Account and tracking audit (45 min)

Using Sections 3–5 and 11–12, check the business portfolio (owner, admins, 2FA), ad account (currency, time zone, payment), Page–Instagram–WhatsApp links and the Pixel (Pixel Helper, Test events). List what is missing and how to fix it.

Exercise B · Competitor research in the Ad Library (30 min)

Following Section 8, find 3 competitors' ads in the Meta Ad Library (country: Mauritius). For each, note format, hook, offer, language, destination and how long it has been running. Write 3 opportunities for your business.

Exercise C · Build a campaign in Ads Manager (60 min)

Following Section 13, build (but don't necessarily publish) one click-to-WhatsApp or lead campaign, and one campaign with another objective. Build at least one custom audience (Section 15). Take screenshots of each level.

Exercise D · Creative variations and A/B test plan (45 min)

Using Sections 20–21 and 23, write 3 really different creative concepts for one campaign (hook, visual, primary text, headline, CTA) and an A/B test plan: hypothesis, variable, metric, budget and length.

Exercise E · Excel: Meta campaign analysis (60 min)

Download the Week 8 Excel exercise from the platform. You will calculate CPM, CTR, CPC, frequency, cost per lead and ROAS by ad set (Section 25), compare two creatives in an A/B test (Section 23), plan audiences and budget with forecasts (Section 10), and write a creative brief.

Deliverable: the Meta Launch Plan

Part	Content
1. Business, goal and KPIs	Summary, SMART objective, target cost per lead or sale, or ROAS
2. Foundations	Account and tracking audit results and fixes (Exercise A)
3. Competitor insights	Ad Library findings (Exercise B)
4. Campaign structure	2–3 campaigns: objective, conversion location, optimisation, budget (table like Section 28)
5. Audiences	For each ad set: location, age, Advantage+ or manual, custom audiences, lookalikes, exclusions
6. Creative variations	3+ concepts per main campaign, with formats and text (Exercise D)
7. Testing plan	One A/B test with hypothesis and success metric
8. Budget and forecast	Monthly budget split and expected results (CPM, CTR, conversion rate)
9. Measurement	Columns, attribution setting, UTM tags, WhatsApp labels, monthly report

Submit your Meta Launch Plan (Google Doc, Slides or PDF link, 6–10 pages) and your Excel file on the learning platform, Module 8 exercises.

TEMPLATES

Copy-and-use templates

Campaign plan

	Campaign 1	Campaign 2	Campaign 3
Name			
Objective			
Conversion location and goal			
Audience (ad sets)			
Placements			
Creatives (3+)			
Budget (daily or lifetime)			
KPI and target			

Creative brief (one per concept)

Field	Your answer
Concept name and angle	
Audience and stage (See, Think, Do, Care)	
Hook (first 3 seconds or first line)	
Visual (format, ratio, what we see)	
Primary text	
Headline	
Call to action and destination	
Proof (review, result, guarantee)	

A/B test log

Date	Hypothesis	Variable	Metric	A result	B result	Uplift	Decision

SECTION 30

Launch checklist, mistakes and glossary

Meta campaign launch checklist

- ☐ Business portfolio owns Page, Instagram, WhatsApp, ad account and dataset; 2+ admins with 2FA
- ☐ Ad account currency and time zone correct; payment method and backup work
- ☐ Pixel and Conversions API tested; Purchase sends value and currency; domain verified
- ☐ Objective matches the business goal; one objective per campaign
- ☐ Conversion location and optimisation event correct
- ☐ Location (and tourist markets) correct; minimum age respects the law
- ☐ Custom audiences built; recent customers excluded from acquisition ads
- ☐ 3–6 different creatives in 9:16 and 4:5; safe zones checked; text proofread
- ☐ Advantage+ creative enhancements reviewed one by one
- ☐ Destination works on mobile; UTM parameters added; WhatsApp greeting set
- ☐ Special ad category declared if needed; ad follows policies
- ☐ Team ready to answer chats and call leads; labels set up
- ☐ Columns preset saved; report date in the diary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Boosting posts with no goal	Use Ads Manager with the right objective
Choosing Traffic when you want sales	Optimise for the action closest to money
No Pixel, no tracking	Install and test tracking before spending
Five ad sets with Rs 200 a day each	Fewer ad sets with more budget
Editing every day	Let the learning phase finish; change slowly
One creative for months	Several concepts; refresh every 2–4 weeks
Judging on cost per click or chat only	Track cost per customer and ROAS
Slow replies to WhatsApp leads	Reply in minutes; use quick replies and labels
Running ads from a personal or agency account	The business owns its portfolio and ad account

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Ads Manager	Meta’s tool to create, manage and report on ads
Business portfolio	Meta’s container (formerly Business Manager) that owns Pages, ad accounts, datasets and access
Objective	The campaign’s goal: Awareness, Traffic, Engagement, Leads, App promotion or Sales
Ad set	The level that holds audience, placements, budget, schedule and optimisation
Advantage+	Meta’s AI automation for audiences, placements, budgets, creative and whole campaigns
Advantage campaign budget	One budget shared between ad sets (formerly CBO)
Meta Pixel / dataset	Website code that sends events to Meta / the container for all your event data
Conversions API (CAPI)	Sends events from your server or CRM to Meta
Event Match Quality	Score showing how well your events can be matched to Meta accounts
Custom audience	People who already interacted with you (visitors, customers, viewers)
Lookalike audience	New people similar to a source audience
Placement	Where an ad appears (Feed, Stories, Reels, Messenger, Audience Network…)
Learning phase	Period after launch or a big edit while Meta learns (about 50 events in 7 days)
CPM / CPC / CTR	Cost per 1,000 impressions / cost per link click / link clicks ÷ impressions
Frequency	Average times each person saw the ad (impressions ÷ reach)
ROAS	Return on ad spend: revenue ÷ ad spend
Attribution setting	The window in which a conversion is credited to an ad after a click, engagement or view
Instant form	A lead form that opens inside Facebook or Instagram
Click-to-WhatsApp ad	An ad whose button opens a WhatsApp chat with the business
Special ad category	Financial, employment, housing or political ads with restricted targeting
Ad Library	Public database of all active ads on Meta